

County Administration Workshop: May 7, 2026

1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron Smith; Colene Martin; Gary Richardson; and Kassie Austin, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Community Justice

1. FOPPO Collective Bargaining

Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, requested authorization from the Board to begin preliminary collective bargaining discussions with the FAPO bargaining unit, identified as the Parole and Probation Officers Association. Hyde explained that the bargaining unit is unique to Community Corrections and currently consists of approximately fifteen to sixteen members. He further advised that the existing labor agreement is set to expire June 30, 2026.

Hyde explained that the initial bargaining sessions would primarily involve technical and procedural contract discussions rather than substantive economic proposals. He stated that historically, the County had begun preliminary negotiations internally before involving outside legal counsel, unless negotiations advanced toward arbitration or more complex matters.

Discussion occurred regarding the County's transition to new employment legal counsel and the importance of including Human Resources, Finance, and legal counsel in communications throughout the negotiation process. Commissioner Martin advised that while initial conversations and information gathering could proceed, substantive proposals or agreements should not be finalized until legal counsel had been fully incorporated into the process.

Hyde stated that the intent was to begin preliminary discussions, identify bargaining topics, and return to the Board with proposed redlined changes and recommendations at the appropriate stage of negotiations. Commissioners expressed support for beginning the preliminary bargaining discussions and encouraged Community Justice staff to continue acting as good stewards for the County during negotiations.

No formal motion was made. The Board provided consensus authorization for Community Justice to begin preliminary bargaining discussions consistent with Board direction.

b. Forestry

1. Out of State Travel Request

Forestry Director Tom Streeter presented a request for approval of out-of-state travel for Brian Braddock, Forester II, to attend a weed control and herbicide application seminar in Burney, California. Streeter explained that attendance would assist Braddock in maintaining required pesticide and chemical applicator licensing credits while also providing opportunities to review herbicide application trials and network with other forestry professionals.

Discussion occurred regarding whether similar certification opportunities were available online. Streeter advised that while online opportunities do exist and have been utilized previously, the in-person seminar would provide more practical field-related training and networking opportunities. Commissioners also briefly discussed forestry-related facilities and herbicide vendors associated with the seminar.

The Board approved the out-of-state travel request without objection.

3. BOARD BUSINESS

a. Anne G. Basker Rental Application for Josephine County Circuit Court

The Board reviewed a rental application request for use of the Anne G. Basker Auditorium by Josephine County Circuit Court. The application was approved without objection.

b. Appointment to the Josephine County Housing and Community Development Council

The Board reviewed an application for appointment to the Josephine County Housing and Community Development Council. *Commissioner Martin made a motion to appoint Haley Strimple to the Council. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Motion carried 2-0.*

c. Conklin Avenue Townhomes Plat Map

The Board reviewed the proposed Conklin Avenue Townhomes plat map. Discussion occurred regarding recent state middle housing regulations intended to encourage increased housing density through smaller lot sizes. Commissioners noted that the proposal involved four smaller residential lots within one of the County's older neighborhoods and discussed the importance of expanding housing opportunities within the community.

Commissioners additionally discussed:

- Support previously expressed by the Urban Planning Commission regarding middle housing concepts
- Site layout and access considerations
- Compatibility with the surrounding neighborhood
- The need for additional housing development opportunities within the County

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the Conklin Avenue Townhomes plat map. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Motion carried 2-0.

4. OTHER

Commissioner Martin introduced discussion regarding a proposed personal services contract with former Josephine County Finance Director Arthur O'Hare to serve in an interim finance support capacity during the transition following Ruth Nelson's retirement. Ruth Nelson and Arthur O'Hare joined the Board for discussion regarding the proposed contract.

Commissioners discussed review of the contract by Legal Counsel, including provisions related to contract structure, scope of services, scheduling expectations, and independent contractor status. Arthur O'Hare explained that the compensation structure was based on the Finance Director salary schedule at a mid-range step equivalent and estimated approximately twenty hours per week of services. O'Hare outlined his anticipated schedule and responsibilities, which included:

Monday availability to organize and prepare weekly finance and budget matters

Attendance at Tuesday and Thursday budget meetings and Administrative Workshops

Availability to County personnel for finance-related guidance and continuity support

Assistance with the County budget process through June 30, 2026

Discussion also occurred regarding the importance of maintaining continuity during the budget process, flexibility in scheduling, and O'Hare's prior experience serving sixteen years with the County, including ten years as Controller and six years as Finance Director. Commissioners expressed appreciation for O'Hare's willingness to assist the County during the transition period.

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the personal services contract with Arthur O'Hare as presented. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call; Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Motion carried 2-0.

5. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

None heard.

The meeting adjourned at 1:54 p.m.